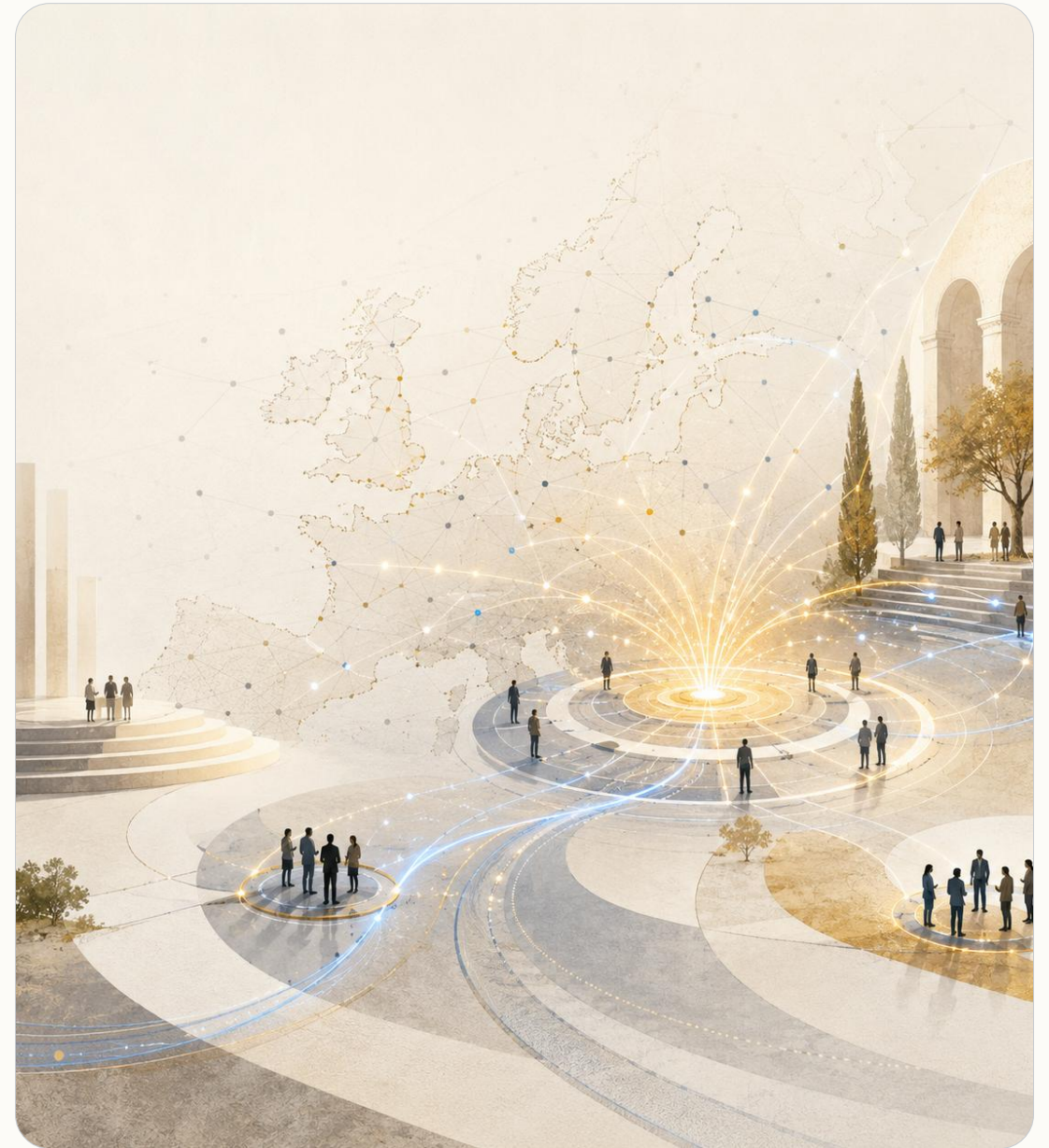


AI for ISKCON Leadership

Leadership, governance and organisational application

part one of two



AI Is Already Inside the Organisation

88%

of surveyed organisations report using AI in at least one business function

362

AI incidents recorded in 2025, against 233 in 2024

Stanford AI Index 2026 · adoption figure via McKinsey

7%

of surveyed nonprofits report major gains in capacity and strategic priorities

THE GAP

Use is common. Measured benefit and control are rare.

Virtuous 2026 report · 346 nonprofits

THE CONDITION

It arrives through email, documents, search and meeting tools, without anyone deciding to adopt it.

THE CONSEQUENCE

If no policy exists, staff invent one.

When the Assistant Can Act

FULL CONTROL

Permission is the real setting

Given access, an assistant can open, change and delete files, send messages and reach connected systems. The account it borrows decides how far it reaches.

UNATTENDED

No one is watching

Left running alone, it continues past its first mistake. A wrong instruction repeated quickly is harder to undo than a wrong sentence.

THE BOUNDARY

Limits are agreed first

Decide in advance which actions need confirmation, which information stays out, and who is able to stop a run that has started.

One authorised assistant reaches further than one person's desk. Its limits are agreed before the task begins.

Benefits and Risks of AI in Our Work

Each use needs someone who checks the result and takes responsibility.

AREA	WHAT WE GAIN	RISK WITHOUT REVIEW
Drafting	Faster letters, minutes and reports	Unreviewed messages sent in our name
Language	Drafts in more languages	Errors in meaning and terminology
Memory	Searchable resolutions and records	Invented quotations and wrong references
Analysis	Faster research and comparison	Unsupported conclusions that sound certain
Capacity	More time for devotee care and service	Fewer opportunities to train successors
Voice	Easier access to recordings and texts	Fabricated words in a familiar voice
Suppliers	Capability we do not have to build	Dependence on a few providers and their terms
Rules	Clear expectations once they are set	Requirements in Europe keep changing by use case

Whose Voice Is It?

A labelled AI demonstration is played here in the room: a familiar face and a familiar voice saying words that were never spoken. The recording is not included in this file and is not distributed. Permission from BBT covers the room only.

The point it makes: a recognisable face and a recognisable voice do not by themselves establish where the words came from. The next slide shows what can be done about that.

Digital Verification for Images, Audio and Video

DIGITAL PROFILES AND SIGNATURES

A digital profile for each file

Record each original's source details and file hash. BBT Archive can digitally sign the record. A checking tool then compares the hash and verifies the signature.

CHECKING QUOTATIONS

AI finds the source

AI finds exact passages and context in BBT Archive. A quotation absent after a full check is suspect. Voice similarity alone cannot authenticate a recording.

THE PRIOR QUESTION

Should such a tool exist?

Before we ask whether an “ask Prabhupāda” service answers accurately, we must ask whether it should exist. A synthesised reply in his person is not his instruction, and devotees may not hear the difference.

PLATFORMS AND LAW

Platform action and legal rights

Content ID matches reused recordings. Rights holders can pursue infringements. EU rules require disclosure of covered deepfakes.

Approved tools should cite the Archive and separate quotation from summary. Whether a personified tool is permitted at all is a decision of its own.

AI Checks in Our Book Production

OUR WORKFLOW

Human translation first

A finished chapter from a human translator, with normal editorial work.
The defined checks run afterwards, never instead.

WHAT THE CHECKS FOUND

Twelve titles, about 2,000 findings

Findings are ordered by severity. The editor accepts or rejects each one, and the confirmed errors are fewer.

THE LARGEST CASE

913,000 lines, 50,000 corrections

A Bulgarian hyphenation dictionary. By hand, two hours a day for three years. With these checks, two hours a day for three weeks.

THE PRECEDENT

The tools have changed before

His Guru Mahārāja called the printing press the bṛhad-mṛdaṅga, the great drum. He dictated these books into a machine. The tools changed; the responsibility did not.

The machine finds. The editor decides.

Questions Answered with Source References

A prepared demo collection

1

50 files with about 23 million words, prepared for this demonstration. The manifest describes this collection's scope.

One question, asked precisely

2

"What did he say about children" returns a thousand statements. A defined question returns a passage we can open and read.

References we can inspect

3

Open the cited verse, letter or transcript. Read the surrounding passage and distinguish quotations from the model's summary.

This demo illustrates source checking. BBT Archive remains the reference.

A Searchable Draft of the ISKCON Law Book

Ordered in 1995

1

A 1995 GBC resolution called for a consolidated Law Book. This demonstration uses the 2018 edition as its starting point.

Assembled overnight

2

Published resolutions from 2019 to 2026 organised under the book's chapters, with references to the source documents.

A draft, and nothing more

3

An unapproved working draft. An authorised committee must review which provisions remain in force and resolve conflicts.

TRY SEARCHING [succession](#) · [child protection](#) · [temple president](#) · [zonal secretary](#) · [sannyasa](#) · [dispute](#) · [trustee](#) · [vyasa-puja](#)

422 pages with search and source links. Legal and institutional review still matter.
[Open it now · haripetrov-stack.github.io/iskcon-law-book](https://haripetrov-stack.github.io/iskcon-law-book)

Writing the Prompt that Works

WEAK

Short generic prompt

“Compare Bulgarian translation and English.” The answer could belong to anything and is discarded.

STRONG

A defined task

“You are checking a finished Bulgarian translation against the English original. Both files are attached. List only the places where the meaning differs: the English, the Bulgarian, and the reason, in a table. Change nothing else.”

THE FOUR PARTS

Role, material, task, form

Who it is. What it has in front of it. What is wanted. In what form.

A useful prompt states the role, source material, task and required format.

From Our Own Work

LIVE DEMONSTRATION

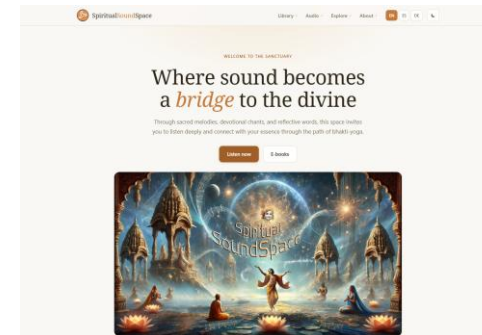
Voice Chat

Demonstrates a good prompt: precise instructions, given by voice.

BUILT IN DAYS

Months of specialist work

Site structure, code, page templates and batch processing of the audio files. A person chose the recordings, the design and the moment to publish.



spiritualsoundspace.com · old website
spiritualsound.space · new website

AI in Devotee Education

THE ASSESSMENT

Whose work are we assessing?

Bhakti-śāstrī and higher qualifications depend on students’ understanding. An essay alone may not establish who wrote it.

THE STYLE

Fluency is not proof

Smooth prose, repeated phrasing and reading aloud can raise questions. AI can also imitate an uneven style and deliberate mistakes.

THE TOOLS

Detectors need human review

Pangram and GPTZero can flag text. False positives and missed AI text occur. A score or a hidden prompt is insufficient evidence.

OUR COURSES

Evidence of learning

Oral defence, drafts and supervised work help assess understanding. Course leaders should define allowed AI use and disclosure.

Where is the line for our own courses, and who draws it?

What It Costs the Person

THE DAY

Work loses its edges

A subscription buys capacity, and capacity invites more hours. Morning programme, japa and rest are the first things those hours take.

THE MIND

The work moves into the head

Less mechanical work, more specifying, judging and checking. That is a heavier kind of tiredness and it is easy to miss in ourselves.

THE HEART

Attachment without a person

Companion applications answer warmly at any hour, and the young are most exposed. Providers added protections after serious cases; the pull remains.

We care for devotees. Their attention and their daily sādhana are part of that care.

Six Questions For This Room

1

Image, voice and likeness

May anyone generate the image, voice or video of Śrīla Prabhupāda, or of a devotee? Should a tool that answers in his person exist at all?

2

Our education

Is AI usage permitted in essays and examinations, and to what extent?

3

Research

How far may AI go in the studies and surveys we commission?

4

Devotee data

What must never be entered into a public tool?

5

Policy ownership

Which policies already exist globally, in Europe and in each yatra? Who is responsible for the gaps?

6

Accountability

Who is responsible when AI goes wrong in ISKCON's name?

These questions need named owners and an agreed process for decisions.

A Request to Begin Policy Work

ELM asks the RGB to begin work on an AI policy for Europe.

01

PART ONE

02

PART TWO

03

BREAK

04

DISCUSSION

Resources from Today's Session



The resource page

Scan the code to open one page. Each item has its own download button and no account is needed.

Demonstrations, the Law Book draft, the corpus manifest and source links.

Check the version date when using a document.

Scan now · haripetrov-stack.github.io/elm-2026-site